[METRIC]

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SUPERSEDING
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# COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

## PENCIL, LEAD DRAWING

This Commercial Item Description has been approved for promulgation by the General Services Administration, office Supplies & Paper Products Commodity Center, New York, NY 10278.

This commercial item description covers black lead drawing pencils intended for fine line writing and used by artists, draftsman, accountants, statisticians, and designers.

## I. Salient characteristics.

A. Pencils shall be wood or paper cased with black lead in diameters as specified in section I E and section VIII. The casing shall be round or hexagonal finished with non-offensive colored lacquer. The length of the pencil shall be not less than 17.4 cm (6 7/8 inches) not including the eraser in conformance with section II B.

B. The eraser shall be in accordance with the latest revision of Commercial Item Description A-A-132 of the eraser type normally used for this type of pencil and shall be crimped or otherwise attached to the casing, by use of a metal or plastic collar.

C. Pencils shall produce marks normally made by pencils, when used on paper. Marks shall be smudge resistant, shall reproduce clearly and shall erase cleanly without ghosting when using a pencil type rubber eraser, artgum eraser or plastic film eraser.

D. Leads shall be continuously smooth marking, and shall not crumble or chip, and shall be of such strength and resilience so as to reduce breakage when used properly.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 7510

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E. The hardness of the leads shall be specified as required. (see section VIII) Diameter shall be uniform throughout the entire length of the lead (see section IIA).

F. The hardness range shall be expressed as a "grade" as defined by ASTM C709. The hardness of the pencil leads shall be such that no inversion shall take place as the density transits from soft to hard for the leads of the same brand. The grades and lack of inversions shall be certified by the vendor to be in conformance with normal commercial practice. The evidence of this conformance shall be available to the government in the form of a chart of line densities for the full range of grades, upon request.

G. Lead shall be centered within the casing and securely bonded (glued) to the casing throughout the entire length. Lead shall be continuously smooth marking, provide clearly visible lines, not crumble or dust.

H. The wood casing shall be straight, the two halves securely bonded (glued) throughout the entire length of the pencil and in conformance with normal commercial practice.

I. When sharpened the wood casing shall not split, splinter or tear, shall present a smooth finish, and the lead shall not crumble or break.

J. Pencils shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark and other normal commercial markings shall be acceptable.

K. The color of the case shall be in accordance with normal commercial practice.

L. When used for purpose intended, pencils will pass the performance test (See section II C).

I. Workmanship. Pencils shall be free from splits, splinter, blisters and any other imperfections which affect the appearance or might impair usage.

II. Tests & Measurements.

A. Diameter - Measurements shall be taken at three points (near each end, and the middle) of each specimen. The mean of the three measurements shall determine the conformance of the specimen.

B. Length - Measurements shall be made once per each specimen selected, using a device with precision of at least 2 mm (0.1 inch.)

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C. Performance Test - Each sample shall be sharpened and tested by drawing a line 60 cm under ordinary writing pressures. The lines shall show uniformity of color and evenness as required by this specification. When drawing a line, the lead shall work smoothly without grittiness on bond paper.

III. Regulatory requirements. The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, to the maximum extent practicable.

IV. Hazardous material requirements.

A. Material safety data sheets. Safety data shall be furnished in accordance with Fed. Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. 313.

V. Quality assurance requirements.

A. Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see VIII), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

B. Lot definition. Each lot of pencils shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the sampling plans specified below. The lot shall be expressed in pencils manufactured from the same materials, at essentially the same time.

C. Examination of the end item for visual defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one pencil. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-3. The AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any pencil containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

| Examine | Defects |
|---|---|
| Workmanship | See Workmanship paragraph |
| Appearance | Not as specified |
| Material | Not as specified |
| Casing | Not glued together |
| Eraser | Loose and not as specified. |

D. Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one pencil. A random

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sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-2. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any pencil containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

The examination for the characteristics listed in the following table will be based on the specifications/requirements listed in NOTES (see section (see VIII. B.) for the specific pencil being examined.

| Examine | Defects |
|---|---|
| Specifications | Not as specified |
| Hardness | Not as specified |

Measurements. Inspection Level S-1 with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective, for each measurements. The sample unit shall be one pencil.

| | |
|---|---|
| Length | Not as specified |
| Diameter | Not as specified |

E. Tests. Sampling for performance testing shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one pencil.

| | |
|---|---|
| Performance Test | Does not comply |

F. Packaging, Packing, and Marking. Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container inspected for conformance with the requirements of section VI.

## VI. Preparation for delivery.

A. Packaging, and packing. Packaging, and packing shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see VIII). The normal commercial number of unit packages shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box used commercially for this item and provide product protection against loss and damage during multiple shipments, handling, and storage. The complete pack shall be in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification and the National Motor Freight Classification. The weight of the shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

B. Marking. Marking shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see VIII).

1. For Shipment To Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See VIII).

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2. For Shipment To Military activities. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See VIII).

3. Additional marking. The shipping containers shall include any precautionary marking required by the National Motor Freight Classification Item 222, Uniform Freight Classification Rule 41, and Department of Transportation regulations.

## VII. Applicable documents.

The following documents, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

A. American Society For Testing Materials (ASTM):
ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

C 709 Standard definitions of terms relating to manufactured carbon and graphite.

B. Public Law and Code of Federal Regulations:
Code of Federal Regulations and Federal Acquisition Regulations are for sale by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

Public Law 94-580 - Use of Recovered Materials
16 CFR Part 1500 - Federal Hazardous Substances Labeling Act.

C. National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc. Agent:
Application for copies shall be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., 2200 Mil Rd., Alexandria, VA 22314.

National Motor Freight Classification

D. Uniform Classification Committee Agent:
Application for copies shall be addressed to the National Railroad Freight Committee, Suite 1120, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.

Uniform Freight Classification

D. Federal Standards, Specifications, and Commercial Item Descriptions:
Federal standards and specifications are available from GSA Business Service Centers and GSA Specification Unit (3FBP-W), 7th and D streets SW., Washington, D.C. 20407.



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Single copies of this specification and other specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Auburn, Washington.

FED-STD-123 Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)
FED-STD-313 Material Safety Data, Transportation Data and Disposal Data for Hazardous Materials Furnished to Government Activities.

E. Military Standards:
Military Standards are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 Marking for Shipment and Storage.

## VIII. Notes.

A. Ordering information. Purchasers should select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

1) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
2) Purchaser shall specify the pencil specifications.
3) Purchasers should specify arrangement for inspection and inspection facilities, if other than specified (See section VI)
4) Purchasers should specify packaging, packing, and any special marking for shipment, if other than required (See section VI).
5) Identification marking, if other than required.
6) If bar code marking is not required.
7) Material safety data sheets required, in addition to those required by Fed-Std-313.
8) Purchasers should specify palletization , if required.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DOD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

Preparing Activity:
GSA-FSS



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